

Chapter 1 — The Rise of Nationalism in Europe

The one-line point: In 1750 the map of Europe had **no nation-states on it**. By 1871 it had Germany and Italy, and the idea that humanity naturally divides into nations had become common sense. This chapter is about **how a political idea invented in 1789 redrew a continent** — and how, within a century, the same idea turned from a liberating creed into the thing that produced the Balkans and 1914.

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Syllabus Classification

Field	Value
Subject	History → World History
Sub-discipline	Political history · history of an idea · state formation
Period	1789 – 1914 (core: 1815–1871)
Prelims (GS Paper I)	★ ★ Congress of Vienna, Mazzini, Zollverein, Bismarck, Garibaldi, Marianne/Germania — clean factual items
Mains (GS Paper I)	★ ★ ★ ★ "redrawing of national boundaries" is a syllabus phrase and this is the chapter that explains it ; also the intellectual background to every anti-colonial nationalism, including India's
Also feeds	Polity ★ ★ ★ (what a nation-state is; federalism vs unitary; the Renan definition is quotable in any answer on Indian nationhood), IR ★ ★ ★ (self-determination, ethnic conflict, the Balkans as the template for modern nationalist wars), Essay ★ ★ ★ ★ (nationalism's double face — liberating and destructive), Indian Society ★ ★ ★ (what holds a diverse nation together — Renan's answer applies directly to India)
Weightage	★ ★ ★ ★
Overlaps with	★ ★ ★ Class 9 Ch.1 (this chapter literally begins where the French Revolution ended), Class 9 Ch.3 (nationalism's dark turn; Versailles), Ch.2 of this book (the Indian variant)

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this chapter you should be able to:

- ☐ **Describe Sorrieu's 1848 print** and explain what made the vision *utopian*. ★ ★
- ☐ ★ ★ ★ ★ **Quote Renan's definition of a nation** and explain why he rejects language, race and religion.
- ☐ **List what the French revolutionaries did** to manufacture a collective identity. ★ ★ ★ ★
- ☐ **State what the Napoleonic Code did**, and why the conquered turned against it. ★ ★ ★
- ☐ **Explain what liberalism meant** in the early nineteenth century — politically *and* economically. ★ ★ ★ ★
- ☐ **Explain the Zollverein**, with the customs-barrier example. ★ ★ ★
- ☐ **State what the Congress of Vienna decided**, and who attended. ★ ★ ★ ★
- ☐ **Explain conservatism after 1815** — and why it was *not* simple reaction. ★ ★ ★
- ☐ **Describe Mazzini's project** and why Metternich feared him. ★ ★ ★
- ☐ **Explain how culture built nations** — Romanticism, Herder, the Grimms, Polish language. ★ ★ ★ ★

- ☐ **Narrate 1848** as *two* revolutions — of the poor, and of the liberals. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Contrast the unification of Germany and Italy**, and explain Britain as the odd case. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Explain the female allegories** — Marianne, Germania — and read Germania's attributes. ★★★
- ☐ ★★★★★ **Explain how nationalism turned into imperialism**, and why the Balkans exploded.

Start Here: Sorrieu's Four Prints, 1848

Frédéric Sorrieu, a French artist, prepared a **series of four prints** in **1848** visualising his dream of a world made up of ★ **"democratic and social Republics"**.

WHAT THE FIRST PRINT SHOWS

The peoples of Europe and America -- MEN AND WOMEN OF ALL AGES AND SOCIAL CLASSES -- march in a long train and offer homage to the STATUE OF LIBERTY as they pass.

Liberty is a FEMALE FIGURE (as in the French Revolution), bearing the TORCH OF ENLIGHTENMENT in one hand and the CHARTER OF THE RIGHTS OF MAN in the other.

In the FOREGROUND lie "the SHATTERED REMAINS of the symbols of ABSOLUTIST institutions."

The peoples are grouped as DISTINCT NATIONS, identified by their FLAGS and NATIONAL COSTUME:

LEADING -> the UNITED STATES and SWITZERLAND (already nation-states by this time)

NEXT -> FRANCE, by the revolutionary tricolour, has just reached the statue

THEN -> the peoples of GERMANY, bearing the BLACK, RED AND GOLD flag

FOLLOWED -> Austria, the Kingdom of the Two Sicilies, Lombardy, Poland, England, Ireland, Hungary and Russia

From the heavens, CHRIST, SAINTS AND ANGELS gaze upon the scene -- used by the artist to symbolise FRATERNITY AMONG THE NATIONS OF THE WORLD.

★★★★★ **The detail that makes the print worth studying:** "at the time when Sorrieu created this image, **the German peoples did not yet exist as a united nation** — the flag they carry is **an expression of liberal HOPES in 1848** to unify the numerous German-speaking principalities into a nation-state under a democratic constitution." **He drew a nation that did not exist, carrying a flag for a country not yet made.** That is precisely what *utopian* means here — "**a vision of a society that is so ideal that it is unlikely to actually exist.**" And note the second thing the print assumes: that nations, once formed, will be **fraternal**. Section 6 of this chapter is about how badly that assumption failed.

Words: ★ **Absolutist** — "a government or system of rule that has **no restraints on the power exercised**. In history, the term refers to a form of monarchical government that was **centralised, militarised and repressive**." ★ **Utopian** — a vision of a society so ideal it is unlikely to exist.

 **Source A — Ernst Renan, "What is a Nation?" (Sorbonne, 1882) — ★★★★★ memorise this**

Renan **criticises the notion that a nation is formed by a common language, race, religion, or territory:**

*"A nation is the culmination of a long past of endeavours, sacrifice and devotion. A heroic past, great men, glory, that is the social capital upon which one bases a national idea. **To have common glories in the past, to have a common will in the present, to have performed great deeds together, to wish to perform still more — these are the essential conditions of being a people.** A nation is therefore **a large-scale solidarity...** ★ ★ **Its existence is a daily plebiscite...** A province is its inhabitant; **if anyone has the right to be consulted, it is the inhabitant.** A nation **never has any real interest in annexing or holding on to a country against its will.** The existence of nations is a good thing, a necessity even. **Their existence is a guarantee of liberty, which would be lost if the world had only one law and only one master.**"*

Word: ★ Plebiscite — a direct vote by which all the people of a region are asked to accept or reject a proposal.

🎯 ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ Why this passage is worth more to you than anything else in the chapter. Renan's definition is **entirely non-ethnic**: not blood, not language, not faith, not soil — but **a shared past and a present consent that must be renewed daily.** For an Indian answer this is decisive: a country of many languages, faiths and ethnicities **cannot** be a nation on the German romantic definition, but is straightforwardly one on Renan's. And *"its existence is a daily plebiscite"* is the single best line available for an essay on why nationhood is an **achievement to be maintained**, not an inheritance to be assumed. ⚠️ Note also the last two claims, which cut in opposite directions: nations should never hold a territory **against its will** (an anti-imperial principle), and a world of many nations **guards liberty** against a single master. Renan is defending nationalism *as a check on empire* — the exact opposite of what it became by 1914.

1 The French Revolution and the Idea of the Nation

★ ★ ★ "The **first clear expression of nationalism** came with the **French Revolution in 1789.**"

The core transfer: *"The political and constitutional changes... led to the **transfer of sovereignty from the monarchy to a body of French citizens.** The revolution proclaimed that **it was the people who would henceforth constitute the nation and shape its destiny.**"*

✂ **What the revolutionaries actually DID to manufacture a nation — ★★☆☆ NCERT asks this directly**

IDEAS	la patrie (the fatherland) and le citoyen (the citizen) -- "emphasised the notion of a UNITED COMMUNITY ENJOYING EQUAL RIGHTS UNDER A CONSTITUTION"
FLAG	a new French flag, the TRICOLOUR, chosen to replace the former ROYAL STANDARD
ASSEMBLY	the Estates General, elected by the body of ACTIVE CITIZENS, renamed the NATIONAL ASSEMBLY
RITUAL	"NEW HYMNS were composed, OATHS taken and MARTYRS COMMEMORATED, all in the name of the nation"
ADMIN	a CENTRALISED administrative system, formulating UNIFORM LAWS for all citizens within its territory
ECONOMY	INTERNAL CUSTOMS DUTIES AND DUES ABOLISHED; a UNIFORM SYSTEM OF WEIGHTS AND MEASURES adopted
LANGUAGE	"REGIONAL DIALECTS WERE DISCOURAGED and FRENCH, as it was spoken and written in PARIS, became the COMMON LANGUAGE OF THE NATION"

★★★★★ **Read that list as a method, not a list of facts — this is the answer to "how is a nation made?"** A nation is built out of **symbols** (flag, hymn, martyrs), **institutions** (assembly, uniform law), **infrastructure of exchange** (no internal customs, one system of measures), and **a standard language**. Every subsequent nationalism in the chapter copies this template, and note the cost buried in the last line: **French national unity was purchased partly by suppressing France's own regional languages**. Nation-building always has an inside victim. (*You met the same instinct in Class 9 Ch.3, and you will meet it again in Britain's treatment of Gaelic below.*)

And then the export: *"The revolutionaries further declared that it was **the mission and the destiny of the French nation to LIBERATE THE PEOPLES OF EUROPE FROM DESPOTISM** — in other words to **help other peoples of Europe to become nations.**"*

- News of the events reached European cities; **students and members of the educated middle classes began setting up JACOBIN CLUBS.**
- *"Their activities and campaigns **prepared the way for the French armies** which moved into **Holland, Belgium, Switzerland and much of Italy in the 1790s.**"*
- ★ *"With the outbreak of the revolutionary wars, **the French armies began to carry the idea of nationalism abroad.**"*

Napoleon — the reforms and the backlash

What he did	Detail
The paradox	★ "Through a return to monarchy Napoleon had, no doubt, destroyed democracy in France , but in the administrative field he had incorporated revolutionary principles in order to make the whole system more rational and efficient "
★★★★ The Civil Code of 1804 (the Napoleonic Code)	did away with all privileges based on birth · established equality before the law · secured the right to property — and "was exported to the regions under French control "
In the Dutch Republic, Switzerland, Italy, Germany	simplified administrative divisions · abolished the feudal system · freed peasants from serfdom and manorial dues
In the towns	guild restrictions removed ; transport and communication improved
★★★ Who gained	"Peasants, artisans, workers and new businessmen enjoyed a new-found freedom." Businessmen and small-scale producers in particular began to realise that uniform laws, standardised weights and measures, and a common national currency would facilitate the movement and exchange of goods and capital from one region to another

But — ★★★ the reaction was mixed, and NCERT is careful about this:

*"Initially, in many places such as **Holland and Switzerland**, as well as in certain cities like **Brussels, Mainz, Milan and Warsaw**, the French armies were **welcomed as harbingers of liberty**. But the initial enthusiasm soon turned to hostility, as it became clear that the new administrative arrangements **DID NOT GO HAND IN HAND WITH POLITICAL FREEDOM**. ★ **Increased taxation, censorship, forced conscription into the French armies** required to conquer the rest of Europe **all seemed to outweigh the advantages of the administrative changes**."*

The evidence NCERT prints: Karl Kaspar Fritz's colour print of the occupation of **Zweibrücken** shows French soldiers **seizing a peasant's cart, harassing young women, and forcing a peasant to his knees**, while a plaque on the **Tree of Liberty** reads — ★ "**Take freedom and equality from us, the model of humanity**" — "a **sarcastic reference to the claim of the French as being liberators**."

 **A liberation that arrives as an occupying army stops being a liberation.** That is a transferable point — hold it against the anti-colonial movements later in this book, and against any argument that good administration substitutes for self-rule. **The Napoleonic case is the cleanest historical proof that efficiency is not freedom.**

2 The Making of Nationalism in Europe

★★★ "If you look at the map of **mid-eighteenth-century Europe** you will find that **there were NO 'nation-states' as we know them today**."

🌿 The Habsburg patchwork — the standard illustration

THE HABSBURG EMPIRE (ruling Austria-Hungary)
"a PATCHWORK of many different regions and peoples"

ALPINE regions -- the TYROL, AUSTRIA, the SUDETENLAND
BOHEMIA -- "where the aristocracy was predominantly
GERMAN-SPEAKING"
LOMBARDY and VENETIA -- ITALIAN-speaking provinces
HUNGARY -- "half of the population spoke MAGYAR while the
other half spoke a VARIETY OF DIALECTS"
GALICIA -- "the aristocracy spoke POLISH"

AND BESIDES these three dominant groups, "a mass of SUBJECT
PEASANT PEOPLES":
BOHEMIANS and SLOVAKS to the north
SLOVENES in Carniola
CROATS to the south
ROUMANS in Transylvania to the east

"Such differences did not easily promote a sense of
political unity. THE ONLY TIE BINDING THESE DIVERSE GROUPS
TOGETHER WAS A COMMON ALLEGIANCE TO THE EMPEROR."

★ ★ ★ That last sentence is the whole problem of the nineteenth century in one line. An empire is held together **vertically** — everyone owes loyalty upward to one person. A nation is held together **horizontally** — people owe something to each other. **Nationalism did not merely change who ruled; it changed the direction in which loyalty ran**, and no multi-national empire could survive that change.

👑 2.1 The aristocracy and the new middle class

Group	Detail
The landed aristocracy	" socially and politically the dominant class on the continent " — united by a common way of life that cut across regional divisions ; owned estates in the countryside and town-houses ; ★ spoke FRENCH for diplomacy and in high society ; families connected by ties of marriage . But " numerically a small group "
The peasantry	the majority of the population . To the west , land farmed by tenants and small owners ; in Eastern and Central Europe , vast estates cultivated by serfs
★ The new classes	Industrialisation began in England in the second half of the eighteenth century , but in France and parts of the German states only during the nineteenth . In its wake came a working-class population , and middle classes of industrialists, businessmen and professionals
★ ★ ★ Who carried the idea	"It was among the EDUCATED, LIBERAL MIDDLE CLASSES that ideas of national unity following the abolition of aristocratic privileges gained popularity." In Central and Eastern Europe these groups were smaller in number till the late nineteenth century

🎯 **Note the aristocracy spoke French across borders.** Europe's ruling class was already **transnational**; it was the **middle class** — tied to a local market, a local language and a local career — that needed a nation. **Nationalism was a middle-class demand before it was anyone else's**, and where that class was small (Central and Eastern Europe) nationalism arrived late.

💡 2.2 What did liberal nationalism stand for? — ★ ★ ★ ★

"The term '**liberalism**' derives from the Latin root **liber**, meaning **FREE**."

POLITICALLY

- "freedom for the INDIVIDUAL and EQUALITY OF ALL BEFORE THE LAW"
- "government by CONSENT"
- since the French Revolution: THE END OF AUTOCRACY AND CLERICAL PRIVILEGES, A CONSTITUTION, and REPRESENTATIVE GOVERNMENT THROUGH PARLIAMENT
- "Nineteenth-century liberals also stressed the INVIOABILITY OF PRIVATE PROPERTY"

BUT NOT DEMOCRATICALLY

"EQUALITY BEFORE THE LAW DID NOT NECESSARILY STAND FOR UNIVERSAL SUFFRAGE."

- in revolutionary France the vote went "EXCLUSIVELY TO PROPERTY-OWNING MEN"
- "Men without property and ALL WOMEN were excluded"
- "Only for a BRIEF PERIOD UNDER THE JACOBINS did all adult males enjoy suffrage"
- "the NAPOLEONIC CODE went back to LIMITED SUFFRAGE and REDUCED WOMEN TO THE STATUS OF A MINOR, subject to the authority of FATHERS AND HUSBANDS"
- "Throughout the nineteenth and early twentieth centuries WOMEN AND NON-PROPERTIED MEN organised opposition movements demanding equal political rights"

ECONOMICALLY

- "FREEDOM OF MARKETS and the ABOLITION OF STATE-IMPOSED RESTRICTIONS on the movement of GOODS AND CAPITAL"

🔗 ★★ ★ **This is the same finding as Class 9 Ch.2** — *nineteenth-century liberals were not democrats*. Seeing it stated twice, in two books, should fix it permanently. **And note the Napoleonic Code cuts both ways:** it abolished privilege of birth (§1 above) *and* reduced women to legal minors. **The same document was emancipatory by class and regressive by sex.**

🚂 **The Zollverein** — ★★ ★ **the best concrete example in the chapter**

THE PROBLEM

Napoleon's measures had created, out of countless small principalities, a CONFEDERATION OF 39 STATES -- "each of these possessed its OWN CURRENCY, and WEIGHTS AND MEASURES."

THE MERCHANT'S JOURNEY, 1833: Hamburg -> Nuremberg

- pass through ELEVEN CUSTOMS BARRIERS
- pay a customs duty of ABOUT 5 PER CENT AT EACH ONE
- duties levied by WEIGHT or MEASUREMENT -- and each region had its own system, so this meant "TIME-CONSUMING CALCULATION"

THE ELLE, the measure of cloth, in each region:

FRANKFURT ... 54.7 cm
MAINZ 55.1 cm
NUREMBERG ... 65.6 cm
FREIBURG 53.5 cm

-- the SAME WORD buying FOUR DIFFERENT LENGTHS of cloth

THE ANSWER -- 1834, the ZOLLVEREIN

"a CUSTOMS UNION formed at the initiative of PRUSSIA and joined by MOST of the German states."

- ABOLISHED TARIFF BARRIERS
- REDUCED THE NUMBER OF CURRENCIES FROM OVER THIRTY TO TWO

"The creation of a NETWORK OF RAILWAYS further stimulated mobility. HARNESSING ECONOMIC INTERESTS TO NATIONAL UNIFICATION. A wave of ECONOMIC NATIONALISM strengthened the wider nationalist sentiments growing at the time."

Source B — Friedrich List, Professor of Economics at Tübingen, **1834**: "*The aim of the zollverein is to **BIND THE GERMANS ECONOMICALLY INTO A NATION**. It will strengthen the nation materially as much by **protecting its interests externally** as by **stimulating its internal productivity**. It ought to **awaken and raise national sentiment through a FUSION OF INDIVIDUAL AND PROVINCIAL INTERESTS**. The German people have realised that **a free economic system is the only means to engender national feeling**.*"

★★★★ List is describing economic integration as a **POLITICAL** instrument, and saying so **openly** — the customs union is not merely convenient, it is meant to *manufacture* a nation by making Germans' material interests overlap. **Germany was economically unified in 1834 and politically unified in 1871: the market came first, and pulled the state after it.** 🔗 The transferable **comparison, worth making in an answer**: this is the logic behind the **European Union** (a customs union hoping to grow a political identity), and behind **India's GST** — *one nation, one tax* is a Friedrich List argument. It is also the **inverse** of what Britain did to India, where a single administered market was created **without** any intention of creating a nation, and got one anyway.

🔵 2.3 A new conservatism after 1815

Word: ★ Conservatism — "a political philosophy that stressed the importance of **TRADITION, ESTABLISHED INSTITUTIONS** and **CUSTOMS**, and preferred **GRADUAL DEVELOPMENT** to **QUICK CHANGE**."

Conservatives believed that "*established, traditional institutions of state and society — like the **monarchy, the Church, social hierarchies, property and the family** — should be preserved.*"

★★★★ But NCERT insists on a subtlety most students miss: *"Most conservatives, however, did NOT propose a return to the society of pre-revolutionary days. Rather, they realised, from the changes initiated by Napoleon, that **MODERNISATION COULD IN FACT STRENGTHEN TRADITIONAL INSTITUTIONS** like the monarchy. It could **make state power more effective and strong**. A modern army, an efficient bureaucracy, a dynamic economy, the abolition of feudalism and serfdom could **STRENGTHEN** the autocratic monarchies of Europe."* 🎯 This is a genuinely important idea and it recurs everywhere. Post-1815 conservatism was **not** anti-modern; it was **selectively modern** — take the army, the bureaucracy and the economy, refuse the constitution. That is exactly the bargain **Bismarck** later strikes (§4.1), and it is the model for every subsequent "modernising authoritarianism." **Modernisation and democratisation are separable, and conservatives discovered it first.**

🏛️ The Congress of Vienna, 1815 — ★★★★★ certain Prelims material

Element	Detail
★★ Who	Representatives of BRITAIN, RUSSIA, PRUSSIA and AUSTRIA — " <i>who had collectively defeated Napoleon</i> "
★★ Host	The Austrian Chancellor, Duke METTERNICH
★★ The object	The Treaty of Vienna of 1815 , drawn up " <i>with the object of undoing most of the changes that had come about in Europe during the Napoleonic wars</i> "

WHAT THE SETTLEMENT DID

RESTORED the BOURBON dynasty, deposed during the French Revolution; FRANCE LOST the territories it had annexed

A RING OF STATES set up on France's boundaries "to PREVENT FRENCH EXPANSION IN FUTURE":

- the KINGDOM OF THE NETHERLANDS, INCLUDING BELGIUM, set up in the NORTH
- GENOA added to PIEDMONT in the SOUTH

PRUSSIA -> "important new territories on its WESTERN frontiers", and a portion of SAXONY

AUSTRIA -> control of NORTHERN ITALY

RUSSIA -> part of POLAND

"But the GERMAN CONFEDERATION OF 39 STATES that had been set up by Napoleon WAS LEFT UNTOUCHED."

THE INTENTION: "to RESTORE THE MONARCHIES that had been overthrown by Napoleon, and CREATE A NEW CONSERVATIVE ORDER IN EUROPE."

And what those regimes were like: "Conservative regimes set up in 1815 were **autocratic**. They **did not tolerate criticism and dissent**, and sought to **curb activities that questioned the legitimacy of autocratic governments**. Most of them imposed **CENSORSHIP LAWS** to control what was said in newspapers, books, plays and songs... The memory of the French Revolution nonetheless continued to inspire liberals. ★ One of the major issues taken up by the liberal-nationalists was **FREEDOM OF THE PRESS**."

The satire NCERT prints — *The Club of Thinkers*, an anonymous caricature of c. 1820. The plaque reads: ***"The most important question of today's meeting: HOW LONG WILL THINKING BE ALLOWED TO US?"*** and the club's rules include: **"1. Silence is the first commandment of this learned society. 2. To avoid the eventuality whereby a member may succumb to the temptation of speech, MUZZLES WILL BE DISTRIBUTED to members upon entering."** 🎯 Note that the target of the joke is censorship, and the medium of the joke is a print — which is exactly why freedom of the press was the liberal demand. **You cannot organise a nation you are not allowed to discuss.** (Ch.5 of this book is the long version of this argument.)

2.4 The revolutionaries — Mazzini

"the fear of repression drove many liberal-nationalists **UNDERGROUND. SECRET SOCIETIES sprang up in many European states to train revolutionaries and spread their ideas**. To be revolutionary at this time meant **a commitment to oppose monarchical forms established after the Vienna Congress, and to fight for liberty and freedom.**"

Giuseppe Mazzini	
Born	★ Genoa, 1805
First affiliation	member of the secret society of the ★ CARBONARI
★ Exile	"As a young man of 26, he was sent into exile in 1831 for attempting a revolution in Liguria "
★★ His two societies	YOUNG ITALY in Marseilles, and then YOUNG EUROPE in Berne — "whose members were like-minded young men from Poland, France, Italy and the German states "
★★★ His belief	" God had intended nations to be the natural units of mankind. So Italy could not continue to be a patchwork of small states and kingdoms. It had to be forged into a SINGLE UNIFIED REPUBLIC within a WIDER ALLIANCE OF NATIONS. This unification alone could be the basis of Italian liberty"
The spread	"Following his model, secret societies were set up in Germany, France, Switzerland and Poland "
★★★ The verdict against him	*"Mazzini's relentless opposition to monarchy and his vision of democratic republics frightened the conservatives. Metternich described him as 'THE MOST DANGEROUS ENEMY OF OUR SOCIAL ORDER'. "*

🎯 Metternich's phrase is the highest compliment in the chapter, and it tells you what conservatives actually feared. Not armies — an idea with an organisation. And note Mazzini's own framing: a **republic within a wider alliance of nations**. He is not a chauvinist; he thinks nations are the natural units of mankind, plural. That generous version of nationalism is precisely what section 6 shows dying. 📌 Class 9 Ch.2 told you that "nationalists elsewhere — including India — read his writings." Mazzini's influence runs directly into the Indian revolutionary tradition.

3 The Age of Revolutions, 1830–1848

"revolutions... were led by the **liberal-nationalists belonging to the EDUCATED MIDDLE-CLASS ELITE**, among whom were **professors, school-teachers, clerks and members of the commercial middle classes.**"

FR July 1830 — and the sneeze

JULY 1830, FRANCE -- "The first upheaval"
The BOURBON kings, restored in the conservative reaction after 1815, are OVERTHROWN by liberal revolutionaries who install a CONSTITUTIONAL MONARCHY under LOUIS PHILIPPE.

METTERNICH: "WHEN FRANCE SNEEZES, THE REST OF EUROPE CATCHES COLD."

The July Revolution "SPARKED AN UPRISING IN BRUSSELS which led to BELGIUM BREAKING AWAY from the United Kingdom of the Netherlands."

GR The Greek war of independence, 1821–32

Element	Detail
Background	"Greece had been part of the Ottoman Empire since the fifteenth century "
★ Start	The struggle for independence began in 1821
Support	"Nationalists in Greece got support from other Greeks living in exile and also from many West Europeans who had sympathies for ancient Greek culture "
★★★ The framing	" Poets and artists lauded Greece as the CRADLE OF EUROPEAN CIVILISATION and mobilised public opinion to support its struggle against a MUSLIM EMPIRE "
★ Byron	"The English poet Lord Byron organised funds and later went to fight in the war, where he DIED OF FEVER IN 1824 "
★★ The end	"the Treaty of Constantinople of 1832 recognised Greece as an independent nation "

★★★ Notice how the Greek cause was sold, because it is a lesson in how solidarity actually gets mobilised. Western Europeans did not rally to Greece out of an abstract love of self-determination — they rallied because **Greece had been rebranded as their own civilisational ancestor**, fighting a Muslim empire. **The claim was cultural and religious, not political.** That is worth flagging honestly: the same public that cheered Greek freedom was, within decades, colonising Asia and Africa. **Nationalism's sympathies were bounded by who counted as "us."**

🔪 3.1 Romanticism — how culture built nations ★★★★★

*"The development of nationalism did NOT come about only through wars and territorial expansion. **CULTURE** played an important role in creating the idea of the nation: art and poetry, stories and music helped express and shape nationalist feelings."*

Element	Detail
Romanticism	"a cultural movement which sought to develop a particular form of nationalist sentiment". Romantic artists and poets criticised the glorification of reason and science and focused instead on EMOTIONS, INTUITION and MYSTICAL FEELINGS
★★ Their aim	"to create a sense of a SHARED COLLECTIVE HERITAGE, a COMMON CULTURAL PAST, as the basis of a nation "
★★★ Johann Gottfried Herder (1744–1803)	claimed "true German culture was to be discovered among the common people — DAS VOLK . It was through FOLK SONGS, FOLK POETRY and FOLK DANCES that the true spirit of the nation (VOLKSGEIST) was popularised. So collecting and recording these forms of folk culture was essential to the project of nation-building "
★★ And the practical reason	"The emphasis on vernacular language and the collection of local folklore was not just to recover an ancient national spirit, but also to CARRY THE MODERN NATIONALIST MESSAGE TO LARGE AUDIENCES WHO WERE MOSTLY ILLITERATE "

Box 1 — the Grimm Brothers. Jacob and Wilhelm Grimm, born in Hanau in 1785 and 1786. Both studied law, then "spent **SIX YEARS travelling from village to village**, talking to people and **writing down fairy tales**", publishing their **first collection in 1812**. Both later became **active in liberal politics**, especially the movement for freedom of the press, and published a ★ **33-volume dictionary of the German language**. ★★ "The Grimm brothers also saw **French domination as a threat to German culture**, and believed that the folktales they had collected were **expressions of a pure and authentic German spirit**. They considered their projects... **as part of the wider effort to OPPOSE FRENCH DOMINATION AND CREATE A GERMAN NATIONAL IDENTITY.**"

🎯 ★★★★★ **Grimms' Fairy Tales is a nationalist political project.** Two lawyers spent six years in villages collecting stories, and compiled a 33-volume dictionary, **in order to prove a nation existed**. Keep this — it is the most memorable possible illustration that **nations are made, not found**, and it transfers directly to any answer about language, folklore and identity in India.

PL Poland — language as a weapon ★★★★★

Poland "had been PARTITIONED at the end of the eighteenth century by the GREAT POWERS -- RUSSIA, PRUSSIA and AUSTRIA."

"Even though Poland NO LONGER EXISTED as an independent territory, NATIONAL FEELINGS WERE KEPT ALIVE THROUGH MUSIC AND LANGUAGE."

- KAROL KURPINSKI "celebrated the national struggle through his OPERAS AND MUSIC, turning folk dances like the POLONAISE and MAZURKA into NATIONALIST SYMBOLS"

After Russian occupation, "the POLISH LANGUAGE was FORCED OUT OF SCHOOLS and the RUSSIAN language was IMPOSED everywhere."

1831 -- an ARMED REBELLION against Russian rule "was ultimately CRUSHED."

"Following this, many members of the CLERGY in Poland began to USE LANGUAGE AS A WEAPON OF NATIONAL RESISTANCE. POLISH was used for CHURCH GATHERINGS and ALL RELIGIOUS INSTRUCTION."

"As a result, A LARGE NUMBER OF PRIESTS AND BISHOPS WERE PUT IN JAIL OR SENT TO SIBERIA by the Russian authorities AS PUNISHMENT FOR THEIR REFUSAL TO PREACH IN RUSSIAN."

"The use of Polish came to be seen as A SYMBOL OF THE STRUGGLE AGAINST RUSSIAN DOMINANCE."

★★★★★ **Poland is the proof of Renan's argument in reverse.** The state was abolished, the territory partitioned among three empires, the language banned from schools — **and the nation survived anyway**, in operas, mazurkas and sermons. Priests went to **Siberia for the language they preached in**. **A nation can outlive its state, because it lives in what people do together.** If you use one example in an essay on culture and identity, use this one.

📦 3.2 Hunger, hardship and popular revolt

The 1830s were "years of great economic hardship in Europe":

- ★ "an **enormous increase in population** all over Europe. In most countries there were **more seekers of jobs than employment**."
- "Population from rural areas migrated to the cities to live in **overcrowded slums**."
- ★★ "Small producers in towns were often faced with **stiff competition from imports of cheap machine-made goods from England**, where industrialisation was more advanced" — "especially so in **textile production**, carried out mainly **in homes or small workshops** and **only partly mechanised**."
- "In those regions where the aristocracy still enjoyed power, **peasants struggled under the burden of feudal dues and obligations**."
- "The rise of food prices or a year of bad harvest led to **widespread pauperism in town and country**."

1848 in Paris: "Food shortages and widespread unemployment brought the population of Paris out on the roads. **Barricades were erected** and Louis Philippe was forced to flee. A National Assembly proclaimed a Republic, granted suffrage to **ALL ADULT MALES ABOVE 21**, and guaranteed **THE RIGHT TO WORK**. **NATIONAL WORKSHOPS** to provide employment were set up."

The Silesian weavers, 1845 — ★★☆☆ read this closely

The journalist Wilhelm Wolff described events in a Silesian village:

*"In these villages (with 18,000 inhabitants) cotton weaving is the most widespread occupation... The misery of the workers is extreme. THE DESPERATE NEED FOR JOBS HAS BEEN TAKEN ADVANTAGE OF BY THE CONTRACTORS TO REDUCE THE PRICES OF THE GOODS THEY ORDER..."

On 4 June at 2 p.m. a large crowd of weavers emerged from their homes and marched IN PAIRS up to the mansion of their contractor demanding higher wages. They were treated with scorn and threats alternately. Following this, a group forced their way into the house, smashed its elegant window-panes, furniture, porcelain... another group broke into the storehouse and plundered it of supplies of cloth which they tore to shreds... The contractor fled with his family to a neighbouring village which, however, REFUSED TO SHELTER SUCH A PERSON. He returned 24 hours later having requisitioned the army. In the exchange that followed, ★ ELEVEN WEAVERS WERE SHOT."*

 ★★☆☆ Three details worth noticing, because they show what a "revolt" actually looks like. They marched in pairs — this was orderly, not a mob. They destroyed the storehouse and the porcelain — the symbols of the contractor's wealth, precisely targeted. And the neighbouring village refused to shelter him, which tells you the contractor had lost the whole district, not just his workforce. Then he came back with the army, and eleven men died. 🔗 Compare the Captain Swing riots (Class 9 supplement) — the same decade, the same squeeze on outworkers, the same targeting of the visible instrument, the same lethal state response. This is what the Industrial Revolution felt like from below, and Ch.4 of this book is its systematic account.

3.3 1848 — the revolution of the liberals ★★☆☆

★★★★ The framing sentence to build any answer on: *"PARALLEL to the revolts of the poor, unemployed and starving peasants and workers in many European countries in the year 1848, a revolution led by the EDUCATED MIDDLE CLASSES was under way."* 1848 was TWO revolutions happening at once — one of hunger, one of constitutions — and the relationship between them decides the outcome (see the Frankfurt collapse below).

Element	Detail
In France	February 1848 brought the abdication of the monarch and a republic based on universal male suffrage
Elsewhere	In Germany, Italy, Poland, the Austro-Hungarian Empire — " <i>men and women of the liberal middle classes combined their demands for constitutionalism with national unification</i> ", pushing for a constitution, freedom of the press and freedom of association
★ ★ The Frankfurt Parliament	Political associations of middle-class professionals, businessmen and prosperous artisans met at Frankfurt and voted for an all-German National Assembly . On ★ 18 May 1848 , 831 elected representatives marched in a festive procession to the ★ Church of St Paul
What they drafted	" <i>a constitution for a German nation to be headed by a monarchy subject to a parliament</i> "
★ ★ ★ The refusal	" <i>When the deputies offered the crown on these terms to FRIEDRICH WILHELM IV, King of Prussia, HE REJECTED IT and joined other monarchs to OPPOSE THE ELECTED ASSEMBLY</i> "
★ ★ ★ ★ Why it collapsed	" <i>While the opposition of the aristocracy and military became stronger, the SOCIAL BASIS OF PARLIAMENT ERODED. The parliament was dominated by the middle classes WHO RESISTED THE DEMANDS OF WORKERS AND ARTISANS and CONSEQUENTLY LOST THEIR SUPPORT. In the end troops were called in and the assembly was forced to disband</i> "

★ ★ ★ ★ That last row is the most important causal sentence in the chapter. The liberals were **crushed from above** (king, aristocracy, army) only *after* they had **cut themselves off from below** by refusing the workers' and artisans' demands. **A movement that will not carry the poor cannot survive the state.** 🔗 **Hold this against Ch.2 of this book.** The decisive difference between the Frankfurt liberals of 1848 and the Indian National Congress after 1919 is exactly this: **Gandhi took the movement to the peasants.** That comparison — made in one sentence — will lift an answer on either chapter.

👤 **The woman question in 1848 — ★ ★ ★ NCERT gives you three voices, use all three**

Word: ★ Feminist — "awareness of women's rights and interests based on the belief of the social, economic and political equality of the genders."

What women had done: "*large numbers of women had **participated actively over the years**. Women had **formed their own political associations, founded newspapers and taken part in political meetings and demonstrations.***" **What they got:** ★ ★ "*Despite this they were **denied suffrage rights during the election of the Assembly**. When the Frankfurt parliament convened in the Church of St Paul, **WOMEN WERE ADMITTED ONLY AS OBSERVERS TO STAND IN THE VISITORS' GALLERY.***"

Voice	Position
★ Carl Welcker , liberal politician, elected member of the Frankfurt Parliament	***Nature has created men and women to carry out DIFFERENT FUNCTIONS... Man, the stronger, the bolder and freer of the two, has been designated as protector of the family, its provider, meant for public tasks in the domain of law, production, defence. Woman, the weaker, dependent and timid, requires the protection of man. Her sphere is the home, the care of the children, the nurturing of the family... Do we require any further proof that given such differences, EQUALITY BETWEEN THE SEXES WOULD ONLY ENDANGER HARMONY AND DESTROY THE DIGNITY OF THE FAMILY?"**
★★★ Louise Otto-Peters (1819–95), founder of a women's journal and a feminist political association — first issue, 21 April 1849	***Let us ask how many men, possessed by thoughts of living and dying for the sake of Liberty, would be prepared to fight for the freedom of THE ENTIRE PEOPLE, of ALL HUMAN BEINGS? When asked this question, they would all too easily respond with a 'Yes!', though their untiring efforts are intended for the benefit of ONLY ONE HALF of humanity — men. ★★ But LIBERTY IS INDIVISIBLE! Free men therefore must not tolerate to be surrounded by the unfree..."*
★★ An anonymous reader , letter to the same paper, 25 June 1850	"It is indeed <i>ridiculous and unreasonable to deny women political rights even though they enjoy the right to PROPERTY which they make use of. They perform functions and assume responsibilities without however getting the benefits that accrue to men for the same... Is it not a disgrace that even the stupidest cattle-herder possesses the right to vote, simply because he is a man, whereas highly talented women owning considerable property are excluded?</i>"

🌀 ★★★★★ **Note that the three arguments are of three different kinds, and a good answer says so.** Welcker argues from **nature** (the standard move — dress a social arrangement as biology; you met it in Class 9 Ch.1 with Chaumette and in Ch.3 with the Nazi cult of motherhood). Otto-Peters argues from **principle: liberty is indivisible** — a freedom that stops at half of humanity is not a principle but a privilege. The anonymous reader argues from **consistency**: the liberal creed already ties rights to property, so **on liberalism's own terms** a propertied woman outranks a propertyless man. **The second is the moral argument; the third is the one that liberals could not answer.**

The aftermath — ★★★★★ do not write off 1848 as a failure:

***"Though **conservative forces were able to suppress liberal movements in 1848, THEY COULD NOT RESTORE THE OLD ORDER.** Monarchs were beginning to realise that **THE CYCLES OF REVOLUTION AND REPRESSION COULD ONLY BE ENDED BY GRANTING CONCESSIONS to the liberal-nationalist revolutionaries.** Hence, in the years after 1848, the autocratic monarchies of Central and Eastern Europe began to introduce the changes that had already taken place in Western Europe before 1815. Thus ★ **serfdom and bonded labour were abolished both in the Habsburg dominions and in Russia. The Habsburg rulers granted more autonomy to the Hungarians in 1867.**"*

4 The Making of Germany and Italy

★★★★★ **The turn that defines the second half of the century: ***"After 1848, nationalism in Europe **MOVED AWAY FROM ITS ASSOCIATION WITH DEMOCRACY AND REVOLUTION.** Nationalist sentiments were often **mobilised by CONSERVATIVES for promoting STATE POWER and achieving POLITICAL DOMINATION over Europe.**"*

DE 4.1 Germany — can the army be the architect of a nation?

1848 The LIBERAL initiative to nation-building -- middle-class Germans trying to unite the confederation into a nation-state governed by an ELECTED PARLIAMENT -- is REPRESSED by "the combined forces of the MONARCHY and the MILITARY, supported by the large landowners (called JUNKERS) of Prussia."

"From then on, PRUSSIA took on the leadership of the movement for national unification."

The architect: chief minister OTTO VON BISMARCK, "carried out with the help of the PRUSSIAN ARMY AND BUREAUCRACY."

THREE WARS OVER SEVEN YEARS -- with AUSTRIA, DENMARK and FRANCE -- "ended in PRUSSIAN VICTORY and completed the process of unification."

18 JANUARY 1871 -- "On the bitterly cold morning", an assembly of the PRINCES of the German states, REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ARMY and PRUSSIAN MINISTERS including BISMARCK gathered in the UNHEATED HALL OF MIRRORS in the PALACE OF VERSAILLES to proclaim the new German Empire headed by KAISER WILLIAM I of Prussia.

And what the new state did: *"The nation-building process in Germany had demonstrated **the dominance of Prussian state power**. The new state placed a **strong emphasis on MODERNISING THE CURRENCY, BANKING, LEGAL AND JUDICIAL SYSTEMS** in Germany. **Prussian measures and practices often became a model for the rest of Germany.**"*

★★★★ The chapter's own section heading is a question — "Can the army be the architect of a nation?" — and you should answer it. Germany was unified, but **by conquest from above rather than consent from below**: the liberals who wanted it in 1848 were crushed, and the conservatives who crushed them delivered it in 1871. The nation arrived **without** the constitutionalism that was supposed to come with it. ★ **Note where the ceremony was held: in the palace of a defeated France.** A nation founded on a battlefield victory, proclaimed in the enemy's own hall, and modelled on Prussian military-bureaucratic power. **The Versailles of 1871 and the Versailles of 1919 are the same room** (*Class 9 Ch.3*) — and the humiliation ran both ways, fifty years apart. **That symmetry is worth one sentence in any answer on German nationalism.**

Π 4.2 Italy unified

Element	Detail
The fragmentation	"During the middle of the nineteenth century, Italy was divided into SEVEN STATES , of which only one, SARDINIA-PIEDMONT, was ruled by an ITALIAN princely house " — the north under the Austrian Habsburgs, the centre ruled by the Pope, the south under the Bourbon kings of Spain
★ Even the language	"the Italian language had not acquired one common form and still had many regional and local variations "
Mazzini's phase (1830s)	a programme for a unitary Italian Republic , and the secret society Young Italy . "The failure of revolutionary uprisings both in 1831 and 1848 " meant the mantle passed to Sardinia-Piedmont under King VICTOR EMMANUEL II
★★ The motive of the elites	"In the eyes of the ruling elites of this region, a unified Italy offered them the possibility of ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT and POLITICAL DOMINANCE "
★★ Cavour	Chief Minister who led the movement — "was NEITHER A REVOLUTIONARY NOR A DEMOCRAT . Like many other wealthy and educated members of the Italian elite, he spoke FRENCH much better than he did ITALIAN "
★★ 1859	Through "a tactful diplomatic alliance with FRANCE engineered by Cavour", Sardinia-Piedmont defeated the Austrian forces
★★ 1860	Garibaldi's armed volunteers marched into South Italy and the Kingdom of the Two Sicilies and "succeeded in winning the support of the local peasants in order to drive out the Spanish rulers "
★★ 1861	Victor Emmanuel II proclaimed king of united Italy

Box 2 — Garibaldi. "perhaps the **most celebrated of Italian freedom fighters**." From a family engaged in **coastal trade**, and a sailor in the merchant navy. In **1833** he met Mazzini, joined **Young Italy**, and took part in a **republican uprising in Piedmont in 1834**; it was suppressed and he **fled to South America, living in exile till 1848**. In **1854** he supported **Victor Emmanuel II**. In **1860** he **led the famous EXPEDITION OF THE THOUSAND to South Italy** — "Fresh volunteers kept joining... till their numbers grew to about **30,000**. They were popularly known as ★ **RED SHIRTS**." ★ **1867**: Garibaldi led volunteers to **Rome**, "to fight the last obstacle to the unification of Italy, **the Papal States where a FRENCH GARRISON was stationed**. The Red Shirts proved **no match** for the combined French and Papal troops. It was only in **1870**, when **during the war with Prussia France withdrew its troops from Rome**, that the Papal States were finally joined to Italy."

🎯 ★★★★★ The line NCERT ends the section with is the one to remember, and it is quietly devastating: *"much of the Italian population, among whom **rates of illiteracy were very high**, remained blissfully unaware of liberal-nationalist ideology. ★★ The peasant masses who had supported Garibaldi in southern Italy had **NEVER HEARD OF Italia**, and believed that '**LA TALIA**' WAS VICTOR EMMANUEL'S WIFE!"* The people who fought for Italy did not know what Italy was. Use this whenever you need to show that **a nation-state can be created before a national consciousness exists** — the state comes first and then has to *make* its citizens, which is exactly the problem India faced in 1947 and which Ch.2 is about.

GB 4.3 The strange case of Britain ★★★★★

★★★★★ "In Britain the formation of the nation-state was **NOT the result of a sudden upheaval or revolution. It was the result of a LONG-DRAWN-OUT PROCESS. There was NO British nation prior to the eighteenth century. The primary identities of the people who inhabited the British Isles were ETHNIC ones — English, Welsh, Scot or Irish. All of these ethnic groups had their own cultural and political traditions.**"

HOW THE "BRITISH NATION" WAS ASSEMBLED

"As the ENGLISH nation steadily grew in WEALTH, IMPORTANCE and POWER, it was able to EXTEND ITS INFLUENCE over the other nations of the islands."

1688 -- "The ENGLISH PARLIAMENT, which had SEIZED POWER FROM THE MONARCHY at the end of a protracted conflict, was THE INSTRUMENT through which a nation-state, WITH ENGLAND AT ITS CENTRE, came to be forged."

1707 -- THE ACT OF UNION between ENGLAND and SCOTLAND, forming "the UNITED KINGDOM OF GREAT BRITAIN" -- which meant "in effect, that ENGLAND WAS ABLE TO IMPOSE ITS INFLUENCE ON SCOTLAND." The British parliament was "henceforth DOMINATED BY ITS ENGLISH MEMBERS."

SCOTLAND: "Scotland's distinctive culture and political institutions were SYSTEMATICALLY SUPPRESSED."

"The CATHOLIC CLANS that inhabited the SCOTTISH HIGHLANDS suffered TERRIBLE REPRESSION whenever they attempted to assert their independence. The Scottish Highlanders were FORBIDDEN TO SPEAK THEIR GAELIC LANGUAGE or WEAR THEIR NATIONAL DRESS, and LARGE NUMBERS WERE FORCIBLY DRIVEN OUT OF THEIR HOMELAND."

IRELAND: "deeply divided between CATHOLICS and PROTESTANTS. The English HELPED THE PROTESTANTS to establish their dominance over A LARGELY CATHOLIC COUNTRY."

After a failed revolt led by WOLFE TONE and his UNITED IRISHMEN (1798), "Ireland was FORCIBLY INCORPORATED into the United Kingdom in 1801."

THE SYMBOLS: "A new 'British nation' was forged through the PROPAGATION OF A DOMINANT ENGLISH CULTURE. The symbols of the new Britain -- the BRITISH FLAG (UNION JACK), the NATIONAL ANTHEM (God Save Our Noble King), the ENGLISH LANGUAGE -- were ACTIVELY PROMOTED and THE OLDER NATIONS SURVIVED ONLY AS SUBORDINATE PARTNERS IN THIS UNION."

★★★★★ Why Britain is in this chapter at all, and how to answer "How was nationalism in Britain unlike the rest of Europe?" Everywhere else, nationalism was a **bottom-up movement against an existing state**. In Britain it was **the state itself, extending outward** — no revolution, no unification war, no Mazzini. But the *content* is not gentler for being gradual: **a banned language, a banned dress, populations driven out, a country forcibly incorporated.** ★ The difference is speed, not **consent**. And note the honest implication NCERT leaves you to draw: the model nation-state, the one "*some scholars have argued*" is the model, was built by **absorbing three other nations** — which is the same operation Britain then performed on a quarter of the world.

5 Visualising the Nation

The problem: *While it is easy enough to represent a **ruler** through a portrait or a statue, **how does one go about giving a face to a NATION?*** **The solution:** artists **personified** it — "they represented a country **as if it were a person**. Nations were then portrayed as **FEMALE FIGURES**." ★ "The female form chosen **did NOT stand for any particular woman in real life**; rather it sought to **give the abstract idea of the nation a concrete form**. That is, the female figure became an **ALLEGORY** of the nation."

Word: ★ **Allegory** — "when an abstract idea (for instance, greed, envy, freedom, liberty) is expressed through a person or a thing. An allegorical story has two meanings, one literal and one symbolic."

Allegory	Country	Detail
★★ MARIANNE	France	*"a popular Christian name , which underlined the idea of a PEOPLE'S NATION . Her characteristics were drawn from those of Liberty and the Republic — the RED CAP , the TRICOLOUR , the COCKADE . Statues of Marianne were erected in public squares to remind the public of the national symbol of unity and to persuade them to identify with it. Marianne images were marked on COINS and STAMPS ."*
★★ GERMANIA	Germany	"In visual representations, Germania wears a CROWN OF OAK LEAVES , as the German oak stands for HEROISM ."

🎨 Box 3 — reading Germania's attributes ★★

Attribute	Significance
Broken chains	Being freed
Breastplate with eagle	Symbol of the German empire — strength
Crown of oak leaves	Heroism
Sword	Readiness to fight
Olive branch around the sword	Willingness to make peace
Black, red and gold tricolour	Flag of the liberal-nationalists in 1848, banned by the Dukes of the German states
Rays of the rising sun	Beginning of a new era

🎯 ★★ The activity NCERT sets is the real question, and it is a good one: in an earlier rendering of 1836, Veit had put **the Kaiser's crown** where he later placed **the broken chain**. **Changing a crown into a broken chain converts a picture of a MONARCHY into a picture of a LIBERATED PEOPLE** — the same female figure, the same nation, an entirely different claim about who it belongs to. **Political arguments were fought in the details of paintings**, because that is where the illiterate majority could read them. ⚠️ And note the pair NCERT prints alongside: **Hübner's *The Fallen Germania* (1850)** — painted immediately after the Frankfurt parliament was dispersed. **The allegory can be shown defeated, and that is a political statement too**. By 1860, in Clasen's *Germania Guarding the Rhine*, the inscription on her sword reads ★ "**The German sword protects the German Rhine**" — the same figure has become **military and territorial**. **Track Germania across 1836 → 1848 → 1850 → 1860 and you can watch liberal nationalism turn into armed nationalism without reading a word of text.**

6 Nationalism and Imperialism — how the idea turned

★★★★★ The thesis sentence of the section — quote it: *"By the last quarter of the nineteenth century nationalism no longer retained its idealistic liberal-democratic sentiment of the first half of the century, but became a **NARROW CREED WITH LIMITED ENDS**. During this period nationalist groups became increasingly **INTOLERANT OF EACH OTHER** and **EVER READY TO GO TO WAR**. The major European powers, in turn, **MANIPULATED THE NATIONALIST ASPIRATIONS OF THE SUBJECT PEOPLES** in Europe **TO FURTHER THEIR OWN IMPERIALIST AIMS**."*

🔥 The Balkans

Element	Detail
★ What it was	"a region of geographical and ethnic variation comprising modern-day Romania, Bulgaria, Albania, Greece, Macedonia, Croatia, Bosnia-Herzegovina, Slovenia, Serbia and Montenegro , whose inhabitants were broadly known as the SLAVS "
Who held it	"A large part of the Balkans was under the control of the OTTOMAN EMPIRE "
★★ The mix that exploded	"The spread of the ideas of ROMANTIC NATIONALISM in the Balkans together with the DISINTEGRATION of the Ottoman Empire made this region very explosive "
The Ottoman attempt	"All through the nineteenth century the Ottoman Empire had sought to strengthen itself through modernisation and internal reforms but with very little success "
★★★★ How the claims were made	"The Balkan peoples based their claims for independence or political rights on NATIONALITY and USED HISTORY TO PROVE THAT THEY HAD ONCE BEEN INDEPENDENT but had subsequently been subjugated by foreign powers. Hence the rebellious nationalities thought of their struggles as attempts to WIN BACK THEIR LONG-LOST INDEPENDENCE "
★★★★ Why that was combustible	"the Balkan states were fiercely jealous of each other and EACH HOPED TO GAIN MORE TERRITORY AT THE EXPENSE OF THE OTHERS "
★★ And the great powers	"Matters were further complicated because the Balkans also became the scene of BIG POWER RIVALRY... Each power — RUSSIA, GERMANY, ENGLAND, AUSTRO-HUNGARY — was keen on countering the hold of other powers over the Balkans, and extending its own control "
★★★★ The result	"This led to a series of wars in the region and finally the FIRST WORLD WAR "

★★★★★ The mechanism to state in an answer, because it is what makes the Balkans a **permanent case study**. Each Balkan people justified its claim by **appealing to a historical maximum extent** — the borders it had held at some past moment of greatness. But those historical maxima **overlap**. So the *same* principle — nationality plus history — gave **several nations a valid claim to the same ground**, and there is no way to adjudicate between them within the principle itself. **Add outside powers each backing a different claimant, and you have a machine for war.** 🔗 This is the direct ancestor of **the twentieth century's worst problems**, and the comparison is worth making: **Versailles' redrawing of boundaries** (Class 9 Ch.3), the **partition of India in 1947**, and every subsequent conflict where two nationalisms invoke history over one territory. ★ **Renan's answer at the start of this chapter is the antidote** — a nation as a *daily plebiscite* of its actual inhabitants, not a claim derived from a map of the past.

🌐 And the anti-colonial turn — ★★★★★ the bridge to Chapter 2

*"Nationalism, aligned with imperialism, led Europe to disaster in 1914. But meanwhile, **many countries in the world which had been colonised by the European powers in the nineteenth century began to OPPOSE IMPERIAL DOMINATION**. The anti-imperial movements that developed everywhere **WERE NATIONALIST**, in the sense that they all **struggled to form independent nation-states**, and were **inspired by a sense of collective national unity, forged IN CONFRONTATION WITH IMPERIALISM**. ★★ European ideas of nationalism were **NOWHERE REPLICATED**, for people everywhere **DEVELOPED THEIR OWN SPECIFIC VARIETY** of nationalism. But the idea that societies should be organised into 'nation-states' came to be accepted as **NATURAL AND UNIVERSAL**."*

🎯 ★★★★★ "Nowhere replicated... their own specific variety" is the sentence that licenses the whole of Chapter 2, and it is the correct answer to any question that implies Indian nationalism was borrowed from Europe. Indian nationalism took the **form** (a nation-state, sovereignty, a flag) but had to invent its own **content**, because it faced problems Europe never did: **not one language but many, not one faith but many, and a hierarchy of caste that European nationalism had no equivalent for**. ★ Anti-colonial nationalism was also forged **NEGATIVELY** — "in confrontation with imperialism" — which is why it could unite groups with almost nothing else in common, and why holding that unity together after the coloniser left proved so hard.

● Prelims traps

Trap	The truth
"Sorrieu's print showed existing nation-states"	★ Only the USA and Switzerland were already nation-states. Germany did not exist — its flag expressed hopes , which is what makes the vision utopian
"Renan defined a nation by common language and race"	★★★★ He explicitly rejected language, race, religion and territory. His nation is a shared past plus present consent — "a daily plebiscite"
"The Napoleonic Code granted universal suffrage"	★★ It abolished privileges of birth, established equality before law and secured property — but went back to LIMITED suffrage and reduced women to the status of a minor
"The French were resisted from the start"	★ They were initially welcomed in Holland, Switzerland, Brussels, Mainz, Milan and Warsaw; hostility came from taxation, censorship and forced conscription
"Liberalism meant democracy"	★★★★ No. Liberals wanted constitution, parliament, rule of law and inviolable private property — but the vote for men of property
"The Zollverein was formed in 1815 by Austria"	★★ 1834, at the initiative of PRUSSIA. It abolished tariff barriers and cut currencies from over thirty to two
"A merchant crossed 39 customs barriers"	★ 11 barriers on Hamburg → Nuremberg, at about 5% each ; the confederation had 39 states
"The Congress of Vienna was hosted by Bismarck"	★★ Duke Metternich , Austrian Chancellor. Attending: Britain, Russia, Prussia, Austria
"Vienna dissolved the German confederation"	★ It was left untouched — 39 states
"Conservatives after 1815 opposed all modernisation"	★★★★ They realised modernisation could STRENGTHEN monarchy — a modern army, efficient bureaucracy, dynamic economy, and even the abolition of feudalism and serfdom
"Mazzini founded the Carbonari"	★ He was a member of it; he founded Young Italy (Marseilles) and Young Europe (Berne) . Exiled 1831 , aged 26
"Metternich called Garibaldi the most dangerous enemy"	★★ Mazzini — "the most dangerous enemy of our social order"
"Greece won independence in 1821"	★ The struggle began 1821 ; the Treaty of Constantinople, 1832 recognised independence. Byron died of fever in 1824
"Herder located German culture in the aristocracy"	★★ In das volk — the common people ; through folk songs, poetry and dances , the volksgeist
"The Grimms only collected fairy tales"	★ Six years of village collecting, first collection 1812 , plus a 33-volume German dictionary , and both were active in liberal politics and press freedom
"The Silesian weavers' revolt was in 1848"	★ 1845. Eleven weavers were shot
"The Frankfurt Parliament met in 1848 with 831 members in the Reichstag"	★★ 18 May 1848, 831 representatives , in the Church of St Paul
"Friedrich Wilhelm IV accepted the crown"	★★★★ He rejected it and joined other monarchs against the assembly
"Women voted for the Frankfurt Parliament"	★★ Denied suffrage; admitted only as observers in the visitors' gallery
"Bismarck unified Germany through four wars"	★★ Three wars over seven years — Austria, Denmark, France . Proclaimed 18 January 1871 at Versailles , Kaiser William I

Trap	The truth
"Cavour was a revolutionary democrat"	★★ "neither a revolutionary nor a democrat" — and spoke French better than Italian
"Garibaldi's Red Shirts numbered a thousand throughout"	★ The Expedition of the Thousand (1860) grew to about 30,000 . Rome joined only in 1870 , when France withdrew its garrison during the war with Prussia
"Britain became a nation-state through revolution"	★★★ "not the result of a sudden upheaval" — Act of Union 1707 with Scotland; Ireland forcibly incorporated 1801 after Wolfe Tone's failed revolt of 1798
"Marianne represented Germany"	★★ Marianne = France (red cap, tricolour, cockade). Germania = Germany (crown of oak leaves = heroism)
"The black, red and gold tricolour was the imperial flag"	★ It was the flag of the liberal-nationalists in 1848, BANNED by the Dukes of the German states

● Mains angles

- ★★★★★ "What steps did the French revolutionaries take to create a sense of collective identity?" — The seven-item list in §1: *la patrie/le citoyen*, the tricolour, the National Assembly, hymns/oaths/martyrs, centralised uniform law, abolition of internal customs and uniform weights, and **standardised French with regional dialects discouraged**. ★ End by noting the cost — **national unity was partly built by suppressing France's own regional languages**.
- ★★★★★ "Explain what is meant by the 1848 revolution of the liberals. What political, social and economic ideas did the liberals support?" — Stress that **1848 was two parallel revolutions** (hunger and constitutions); give liberalism's three faces (political: consent, constitution, parliament, rule of law; social: end of aristocratic privilege but **not** universal suffrage; economic: free markets, free movement of goods and capital, inviolable property); then **why Frankfurt failed — the middle class resisted workers' and artisans' demands and lost its social base**.
- ★★★★★ "Choose three examples to show the contribution of CULTURE to the growth of nationalism." — (i) Romanticism and Herder's *das volk/volksgeist*; (ii) the Grimm brothers' folktales and 33-volume dictionary as an anti-French national project; (iii) Poland — Kurpinski's operas, the polonaise and mazurka, and priests jailed or sent to Siberia for preaching in Polish. Add Delacroix's *Massacre at Chios* mobilising sympathy for Greece if you need a fourth.
- ★★★★★ "Through a focus on any two countries, explain how nations developed over the nineteenth century." — **Germany vs Italy** is the intended pair. Both: fragmented, failed liberal phase (1848 / 1831 and 1848), then unification led by **one strong state** (Prussia / Sardinia-Piedmont) under **one chief minister** (Bismarck / Cavour) **by war and diplomacy**. Differences: Germany by **Prussian army and bureaucracy** with the Junkers behind it; Italy with a **popular-military element in Garibaldi's volunteers** and a **papal obstacle** resolved only in 1870. ★ End on the shared irony: **neither nation was made by the liberals who first wanted it, and in Italy the peasants who fought had never heard of Italia**.
- ★★★★★ "How was the history of nationalism in Britain unlike the rest of Europe?" — No revolution, no unification war, no Mazzini: **the state expanded outward over centuries**. But 1707 and 1801 were **imposition**, Gaelic and Highland dress were **banned**, Highlanders **driven out**, and the older nations survived **only as subordinate partners** under a promoted English culture. ★ **The difference is speed, not consent**.
- ★★★★★ "Why did nationalist tensions emerge in the Balkans?" — Ethnic patchwork + romantic nationalism + Ottoman disintegration + **claims grounded in overlapping historical maxima** + mutual territorial jealousy + **great-power rivalry (Russia, Germany, England, Austro-Hungary)** → wars → the First World War.

- ★★★★★ **Essay/GS1: "Nationalism liberated and then destroyed."** — Trace the arc in one line each: **1789** (sovereignty to the people) → **1830s–48** (Mazzini, liberal-nationalism, culture) → **1848** (defeated but concessions won) → **1871** (unification by conservatives and armies) → **after 1871** (a "*narrow creed with limited ends*") → **the Balkans** → **1914**. ★ **Use Germania's changing attributes as the visual spine of the answer.**
- ★★★★★ **Polity/Society: "What makes a nation?"** — Renan against the ethnic definition; "**a daily plebiscite**"; the **Habsburg problem** (loyalty running vertically vs horizontally); and the direct application to India — **a nation of many languages and faiths is impossible on Herder's definition and unremarkable on Renan's.**
- ★★★★★ **"The role of women in nationalist struggles."** — Participation (associations, newspapers, meetings, demonstrations) against exclusion (**no vote, gallery only at Frankfurt**); the three voices — **Welcker** (argument from nature), **Otto-Peters** ("*liberty is indivisible*"), the **anonymous reader** (liberalism's own property logic); and the female **allegories** — ★ **women were everywhere as symbols of the nation and nowhere as its voters.**

🔗 **Cross-links to build now**

- ★★★★★ **Class 9 Ch.1** — this chapter *starts* where that one ends; the tricolour, the red cap, the cockade, active citizens, and the Napoleonic Code all carry over.
 - **Class 9 Ch.2** — liberals/radicals/conservatives; nineteenth-century liberals were not democrats.
 - ★★★★★ **Class 9 Ch.3** — the **Hall of Mirrors at Versailles** in 1871 and 1919; nationalism's turn to aggression; the redrawal of boundaries.
 - **Class 9 supplement** — the **Silesian weavers** and the **Captain Swing** riots are the same decade and the same squeeze.
 - ★★★★★ **Ch.2 of this book** — "*European ideas of nationalism were nowhere replicated*" is the licence for the whole Indian chapter; and **Frankfurt's failure to carry the workers** is the exact contrast with Gandhi taking the movement to the peasants.
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Glossary

Term	Meaning
Absolutist	Rule with no restraints on power — centralised, militarised, repressive monarchy
Utopian	A vision of a society so ideal it is unlikely to actually exist
Plebiscite	A direct vote by which all the people of a region accept or reject a proposal
Suffrage	The right to vote
Conservatism	Stresses tradition, established institutions and customs ; prefers gradual development to quick change
Feminist	Awareness of women's rights based on social, economic and political equality of the genders
Ideology	A system of ideas reflecting a particular social and political vision
Ethnic	Relating to a common racial, tribal or cultural origin a community identifies with
Allegory	An abstract idea expressed through a person or thing — two meanings, literal and symbolic
La patrie / le citoyen	The fatherland / the citizen
Napoleonic Code (Civil Code of 1804)	Abolished privileges of birth , established equality before law , secured property
Zollverein	The customs union of 1834 , formed at Prussia's initiative
Elle	The measure of cloth — a different length in every German region
Junkers	The large landowners of Prussia
Das volk / volksgeist	The common people / the true spirit of the nation
Carbonari	The secret society Mazzini first belonged to
Young Italy / Young Europe	Mazzini's societies, founded at Marseilles and Berne
Red Shirts	Garibaldi's volunteers — the Expedition of the Thousand , grown to ~30,000
Marianne	The female allegory of France — red cap, tricolour, cockade
Germania	The female allegory of Germany — crown of oak leaves
The Balkans	Romania, Bulgaria, Albania, Greece, Macedonia, Croatia, Bosnia-Herzegovina, Slovenia, Serbia, Montenegro — the Slavs

60-Second Recap

1. ★ **Sorrieu, 1848** — four prints of "*democratic and social Republics*"; peoples march to the **Statue of Liberty** past the **shattered symbols of absolutism**; **USA and Switzerland lead** as existing nation-states; **Germany carries a flag for a nation that did not yet exist** — which is what makes it **utopian**.
2. ★★ **Renan, 1882**: a nation is **not** language, race, religion or territory but "*a long past of endeavours, sacrifice and devotion*", "**a large-scale solidarity**", whose "*existence is a daily plebiscite*"; it "*never has any real interest in annexing or holding on to a country against its will.*"
3. ★★ **1789 transferred sovereignty from monarchy to citizens**, and the revolutionaries manufactured a nation with **la patrie/le citoyen**, the **tricolour**, the **National Assembly**, **hymns**, **oaths**, **martyrs**, **uniform centralised law**, **abolition of internal customs**, **uniform weights and measures**, and **standardised French** — regional dialects **discouraged**.
4. **The French armies carried nationalism abroad** into **Holland, Belgium, Switzerland and Italy in the 1790s**, preceded by **Jacobin clubs**. **Napoleon's Civil Code of 1804** abolished privileges of birth,

established equality before law and secured property, abolished feudalism and serfdom, removed guild restrictions — ★ **but taxation, censorship and forced conscription turned welcome into hostility**, because the administrative changes **"did not go hand in hand with political freedom."**

5. ★ **Mid-eighteenth-century Europe had no nation-states.** The **Habsburg empire** was a patchwork — Tyrol, Bohemia, Lombardy, Venetia, Hungary (**half Magyar**), Galicia (**Polish aristocracy**), plus subject peasant peoples — and **"the only tie binding these diverse groups together was a common allegiance to the emperor."**
6. **The aristocracy** was dominant but small, spoke **French** across borders; the **peasantry** was the majority; and it was among the **educated liberal middle classes** that national unity gained ground.
7. ★ ★ **Liberalism** = individual freedom, equality before law, **government by consent**, constitution, parliament, **inviolable private property — but not universal suffrage**; only the **Jacobins** briefly gave all adult males the vote, and the **Napoleonic Code reduced women to minors**.
8. ★ ★ **Economically**, liberalism meant free markets: a merchant travelling **Hamburg → Nuremberg in 1833** crossed **11 customs barriers** paying ~5% each, and the **elle** bought **54.7 cm in Frankfurt but 65.6 cm in Nuremberg**. ★ **The Zollverein of 1834**, at **Prussia's** initiative, abolished tariff barriers and cut **thirty-plus currencies to two**; railways did the rest. **List: "the aim of the Zollverein is to bind the Germans economically into a nation."**
9. ★ ★ **Conservatism after 1815** preserved monarchy, Church, hierarchy, property and family — **but was not anti-modern**: a modern army, efficient bureaucracy and dynamic economy could **strengthen** autocracy.
10. ★ ★ **Congress of Vienna, 1815 — Britain, Russia, Prussia, Austria**, hosted by **Metternich**: **Bourbons restored**, France stripped of annexations, a **ring of states** built around France (**Netherlands including Belgium** in the north, **Genoa to Piedmont** in the south), **Prussia** gained western territories and part of Saxony, **Austria** northern Italy, **Russia** part of Poland — and the **39-state German confederation left untouched**. Regimes were **autocratic and censorious**, so **freedom of the press** became the liberal demand.
11. ★ ★ **Mazzini** — born **Genoa 1805**, **Carbonari**, exiled **1831** at 26, founded **Young Italy** and **Young Europe**; believed **God intended nations as the natural units of mankind**; **Metternich**: **"the most dangerous enemy of our social order."**
12. **July 1830**: Bourbons overthrown, **Louis Philippe** installed; **"when France sneezes, the rest of Europe catches cold"**; **Belgium** broke away from the Netherlands. **Greece**: struggle from **1821**, **Byron** died **1824**, independence by the **Treaty of Constantinople, 1832** — sold to Europe as **the cradle of civilisation against a Muslim empire**.
13. ★ ★ **Culture built nations**: Romanticism against reason; **Herder's *das Volk* and *Volksgeist***; the **Grimms'** six years of collecting, **1812** collection and **33-volume dictionary** against French domination; and **Poland**, where after the crushed rebellion of **1831** priests **used Polish as a weapon** and were **jailed or sent to Siberia**.
14. ★ ★ **1848 was two revolutions**. The poor: food shortages, unemployment, barricades, **Louis Philippe** fled, a republic with **suffrage for all men over 21** and **the right to work**; earlier, the **Silesian weavers (1845)** marched **in pairs**, were met with scorn, sacked the storehouse, and **eleven were shot**. The liberals: **831 deputies at the Church of St Paul on 18 May 1848**, a constitution offered to **Friedrich Wilhelm IV**, who **rejected it** — and ★ **the parliament lost its social base by resisting workers' and artisans' demands**. **Women were admitted only to the gallery**.
15. **Yet 1848 forced concessions**: **serfdom and bonded labour abolished** in the Habsburg lands and Russia; **autonomy for Hungary in 1867**.
16. ★ ★ **After 1848 nationalism moved away from democracy**. **Germany**: liberals crushed by monarchy, military and **Junkers**; **Bismarck** unified by **three wars in seven years — Austria, Denmark, France** — and **Kaiser William I** was proclaimed on **18 January 1871 in the Hall of Mirrors at Versailles**. **Italy**: seven states, only **Sardinia-Piedmont** Italian-ruled; **Cavour** — **"neither a revolutionary**

nor a democrat", spoke better French than Italian — allied with **France** to beat Austria in **1859**; **Garibaldi's Red Shirts** took the south in **1860**; **Victor Emmanuel II** king in **1861**; **Rome only in 1870**. ★ **The peasants who fought had never heard of Italia.**

17. ★★ **Britain** was made by **no upheaval** — the English parliament that seized power in **1688**, the **Act of Union 1707** with Scotland, **Ireland forcibly incorporated 1801** after **Wolfe Tone's** 1798 revolt; **Gaelic and Highland dress banned**, Highlanders driven out, and the older nations left "**subordinate partners**" under the **Union Jack**, *God Save Our Noble King*, and English.
18. ★ **Allegories: Marianne** (France) — red cap, tricolour, cockade, on **coins and stamps**; **Germania** — **crown of oak leaves** for heroism, **broken chains** for being freed, **sword** for readiness to fight with an **olive branch** for peace, the **black-red-gold tricolour banned by the Dukes**, and **rays of the rising sun** for a new era.
19. ★★★ **After 1871 nationalism became "a narrow creed with limited ends."** In the Balkans, romantic nationalism plus **Ottoman disintegration** plus claims resting on **overlapping historical maxima** plus **great-power rivalry (Russia, Germany, England, Austro-Hungary)** produced a series of wars and finally **the First World War**.
20. ★★★★★ **And yet the colonised took the idea up: anti-imperial movements were nationalist, forged "in confrontation with imperialism" — but ★ "European ideas of nationalism were NOWHERE REPLICATED, for people everywhere developed their own specific variety."**

Test Yourself

Prelims style

1. In Sorrieu's 1848 print, which peoples are shown **leading** the procession? — ***The United States and Switzerland, because they were already nation-states.***
2. Renan held that a nation is — ***not language, race, religion or territory, but a long past of shared endeavour plus present consent — "a daily plebiscite."***
3. The Zollverein was formed in — ***1834, at the initiative of Prussia; it abolished tariff barriers and reduced currencies from over thirty to two.***
4. The Congress of Vienna, 1815, was hosted by — ***Duke Metternich; attended by Britain, Russia, Prussia and Austria; the 39-state German confederation was left untouched.***
5. Consider: (i) Mazzini founded Young Italy at Marseilles. (ii) Metternich called him the most dangerous enemy of the social order. (iii) He believed Italy should become a monarchy. — ***(i) and (ii) only. He wanted a unified republic.***
6. The Frankfurt Parliament — ***met on 18 May 1848 with 831 representatives in the Church of St Paul; the crown was rejected by Friedrich Wilhelm IV, and women were admitted only as observers.***
7. German unification was completed by — ***three wars over seven years, with Austria, Denmark and France; proclaimed 18 January 1871 at Versailles under Kaiser William I.***
8. Match: Marianne / Germania / crown of oak leaves / broken chains. — ***Marianne = France; Germania = Germany; oak leaves = heroism; broken chains = being freed.***

Mains style

9. What steps did the French revolutionaries take to create a sense of collective identity among the French people? **(150 words) ★**

10. Explain what is meant by the 1848 revolution of the liberals. What political, social and economic ideas did the liberals support? **(250 words)** ★
11. Choose three examples to show the contribution of culture to the growth of nationalism in Europe. **(250 words)** ★
12. Through a focus on any two countries, explain how nations developed over the nineteenth century. **(250 words)** ★
13. How was the history of nationalism in Britain unlike the rest of Europe? **(150 words)**
14. Why did nationalist tensions emerge in the Balkans? **(250 words)** ★
15. *"By the last quarter of the nineteenth century nationalism became a narrow creed with limited ends."* Trace how a liberating idea turned destructive. **(250 words)** ★ — *Essay crossover*
16. Discuss the role of women in the nationalist struggles of nineteenth-century Europe. **(150 words)**

Self-check (out loud, no notes):

- Say what made Sorrieu's vision utopian, in one sentence.
- Quote Renan's definition and his phrase about the plebiscite.
- List seven things the French revolutionaries did to build a nation.
- Give the customs-barrier and *elle* figures, and say what the zollverein changed.
- Name who attended Vienna, who hosted it, and four things it decided.
- Explain why post-1815 conservatism was not simply reactionary.
- Give three cultural examples of nation-building, with names.
- Explain in one sentence why the Frankfurt Parliament collapsed.
- Contrast German and Italian unification in three respects.
- Explain the Balkan mechanism, and Renan's answer to it.